

How to view zst file using Vim?

Asked 5 years, 1 month ago Modified 3 years, 1 month ago Viewed 31k times



6

I'm trying to view some log files in zst format. I can use `zstdcat` to view the content, but when I do `vim <filename.zst>`, there're only garbled text. Is there a similar way as `zstdcat` to view zst file with Vim as well?



vim

zstd



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asked Aug 13, 2021 at 3:30



Liutong Chen

3,728 5 29 32

Something like this: stackoverflow.com/a/5463559/7976758 but with different commands — `zstdcat` instead of `gz`. — [phd](#) Aug 13, 2021 at 9:24

vimdoc.sourceforge.net/html/doc/autocmd.html#gzip-example Found in stackoverflow.com/search?q=%5Bvim%5D+open+gzipped+file — [phd](#) Aug 13, 2021 at 9:24

2 Answers

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8

You use Zstandard to compress data so a `*.zst` file is not readable text and there is no point opening it directly in a *text* editor. You will have to decompress it first, which is what `zstdcat` does:



`zstdcat` is equivalent to `zstd -dcf`



and then open the decompressed text in Vim.

To view the content of a `*.zst` file in Vim, from your shell:



```
$ view <(zstdcat filename)
$ zstdcat filename | view -
```

To view the content of a `*.zst` file from Vim:

```
:enew | r !zstdcat filename
```

Note that, in both cases, you are not viewing the `*.zst` file itself but a copy of its decompressed content.

Of course, the whole thing could be streamlined and turned into a plugin similar to `:h zip`.

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edited Aug 13, 2021 at 6:59

answered Aug 13, 2021 at 6:41



romainl

200k

22

304

342

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2

With the [2016 commit](#) this feature was added to Vim in the gzip plugin

To view a file today within the shell, use `vim file.zst`



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answered Aug 1, 2023 at 19:24



pratikpc

772

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22



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